# Port Louis, Mauritius

*The cloudburst kills here, whatever El Niño does. Lock the underground spaces where people drowned in 2013 before the rains, and do not wait for a warning to do it.*

| IMPACT REGION | EXCESS HEAT DEATHS | WINDOW | DOMINANT HAZARD |
|---|---|---|---|
| MUS.Rb4955ae83ec (label unconfirmed): Port Louis with Plaines Wilhems | No figure published for Mauritius | Season Dec 2026 – Mar 2027 | Flash flood; dengue and chikungunya; water deficit |

**15/15 recommendations checked** (the nine actions and six *Do not* cards; the two dropped lens actions below are not in the 15). 0 confirmed, 9 corrected (all nine actions are Partially confirmed), 0 unverified, and 6 contraindicated (the six *Do not* cards). All three funding placements are unverified: none has a published unit cost or a proven Port Louis deliverer. Two further lens actions were dropped in verification: a standalone heat-warning action (unverified: no Mauritian heat-mortality evidence, and the Ahmedabad precedent does not transfer) and an insurance-regulation lever (contraindicated as cited: the 2024 FSC communiqué says the opposite). **The funding target fell twice.** In verification it fell from Rs 11.0M to Rs 3.0M: the cash placement through Lovebridge was contraindicated (it is based in Saint Pierre, gives in-kind help only, and has no Port Louis caseload). On 14 October the flood cash moved to one national line, MU-F01, shared by all six zones and counted outside this envelope, so the Port Louis target is now Rs 1.1M (about $22,900). Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review. It covers heat only and publishes no figure for Mauritius, so this report gives no excess-death number, scaled or otherwise. **Scope.** The Central Water Authority's Port Louis supply zone: the city

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE




20.16°S 57.50°E, Mauritius · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Short streams through the city kill in 90-minute cloudbursts in any ENSO phase: 11 dead in 2013, 1 in Cyclone Belal in 2024.
- **First action.** The City Council gates the Caudan subway and underground car parks and shuts them on a standing rule, by 30 November.
- **The money.** Rs 0.6M / 1.1M / 2.3M ($12k / $23k / $48k): container covers and a flood-alert pilot. Flood cash draws on the national line MU-F01, not counted here.
- **Do not.** Do not shelter from a downpour underground, or cross a ruisseau: that is where people died in 2013.


| | | |
|---|---|---|
| What to do | **9** actions | p. 2 |
| Who does what | RACI chart | p. 10 |
| Where money does the most | funding | p. 10 |
| Do not do this | **6** items | p. 12 |
| What has happened here | the record | p. 15 |
| How this was produced | methodology | p. 17 |
| References | sources | p. 19 |

of Port Louis (Municipal Council area, 140,403 people, Census 2022, Statistics Mauritius, including Pailles) and the zone's western edge beyond it (Coromandel, Richelieu, Albion, Pointe aux Sables, Canot, Gros Cailloux, La Chaumière). The CWA counts 55,383 subscribers. The census publishes no zone total; the GIS base gives about 131,000 (WorldPop 2020 estimate, a different basis from the census figure, so the two are not directly comparable). Terre Rouge, Baie du Tombeau, Le Hochet, and Riche Terre are in the North zone and its briefing. One of six Mauritius briefings aligned to the CWA's supply zones. **The premise.** This is not an "El Niño drought". El Niño explains almost none of Mauritius's rainfall. The MMS bulletin of 10 August 2026 puts October–December rain at about 92% of normal (near-normal to slightly dry), warmer than normal, and the SARCOF-33 regional forecast for January–March 2027 is normal to above-normal rain. The season's hazards are the flash flood, mosquito-borne disease, and a water deficit carried over from a summer that had 66% of normal rain.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO RANKED

Ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. Backing lenses are shown per action; an action several lenses reached independently is the stronger bet.

## 1. By 30 November, gate the Caudan pedestrian subway and the underground car parks in the Ruisseau du Pouce and Canal Dayot basin, and shut them on a standing rule

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN · FRONTLINE | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Municipal City Council of Port Louis, with the Caudan operator and the Police | 30 November 2026 | Gates and keyholder rota. No published figure; unfunded | A repeat of 2013, when most of the dead were found underground |

On 30 March 2013 more than 150 mm fell in under 90 minutes and 11 people died. AFP reported six bodies in a pedestrian subway and two in an underground car park. A 2026 memorial piece places the victims at the Ruisseau du Pouce and Canal Dayot, so the exact sites need confirming with the inquest report, but the pattern is clear: people died in the places they went into to get out of the rain. No closure

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

rule for the subway was found, and the memorial stands at the tunnel entrance, which suggests it is still in use. Port Louis already has a Flood Response and Evacuation Plan naming 16 safe buildings, Caudan among them, and a national weather-closure protocol is being drafted. Write this as a site-closure annex to that plan: a physical gate, a named keyholder for each site, and a rule to close on any MMS torrential-rain warning *or* when the keyholder sees intense rain begin, whichever comes first.

**Correction:** a warning-only trigger is not enough. The documented MMS threshold (2009) is 100 mm of widespread rain within 12 hours. Lead time was effectively zero in 2013, when residents said no warning came, and in Cyclone Belal in January 2024, when the Prime Minister said the rain was not anticipated and the met-service director resigned. A rain-gauge trigger is not yet available: the WMO's Southwest Indian Ocean flash-flood guidance project is still in its data-discovery phase. Until it is, the on-site judgment rule carries the action. The evidence is local; no comparable evaluated programme was found.

## 2. In November, clear the drains of the Ruisseau du Pouce, Canal Dayot, and the Vallijee catchments under the pre-rainy-season cleaning campaign, without waiting for the capital list

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · SKEPTIC | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Land Drainage Authority, with City Council crews | 30 November 2026 | Existing operating budgets; no dedicated line found | Drains already blocked by construction waste overflowing into the streets in the first cloudburst |

Pre-season cleaning is an established routine: on 11 September 2025 the councils and the Land Drainage Authority met at Port Louis city hall to plan clearing 462 km of drains and dredging over 200 km of rivers. This action asks that the three catchments where people have died go first. It does not rely on new money, because new money is not coming in time. The Authority's national list of drain projects (about Rs 993M) went to the Ministry of Finance in March 2026 and is unconfirmed; urgent works under the Flood Management Programme were "blocked since 2019" with 7% done, by the minister's own account; and the Land Drainage Master Plan, finished in May 2022, was released only in August 2025.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**Corrections:** the Master Plan was cleared for publication on 15 August 2025, not simply "in 2025". The Corporate Climate Responsibility levy (2% of chargeable income for companies above Rs 50M turnover) was proposed as a payer for these drains; its proceeds go to a Climate and Sustainability Fund for "adaptation and mitigation", but nothing shows that fund can or does pay for drains, so it is an unproven route, not a payer. Delivery risk is real: the contractor for earlier drain projects finished 7% of them.

## 3. Make "covered" part of every water-storage message, and make a sealed lid a condition of the new Rs 15,000 tank voucher, before the rains

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST · EMERGENCY MANAGER | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ministry of Health and Wellness (vector control), with the CWA and the Ministry of Finance | Messages now; grant condition before the first 2026-27 payment | About zero for the wording. Covers: Rs 600 a household kit, an assumption (no Mauritian quote); see the funding section | Water stored during rationing becoming mosquito habitat in the dengue season |

The CWA has told residents to keep "sufficient water reserves" without saying they should be covered. Every communiqué, SMS, and radio spot about storage should say "covered", and should add a weekly scrub. Community yard clean-ups before November line up with the start of the November–April dengue peak. The tank grant matters because it is about to add storage at scale. About 6,000 households got grants in 2025. That scheme, and the Rs 175M tank line in the 2026-27 budget, is superseded: on 9 October 2026 Cabinet decided on a Rs 15,000 Development Bank of Mauritius voucher for every household without a tank, run by the CWA and the DBM. It buys two tanks (1,000 and 500 litres) and a pump, tenants are eligible, and there is no income test (Mega Business, 11 Oct 2026). No lid or mesh requirement was found in any version. The lid condition is a national ask, shared with the other five zone briefings. The evidence that covers reduce dengue is real but thin: in a 2016 meta-analysis, community environmental management plus container covers gave an odds ratio of 0.22 (95% CI 0.15–0.32), but that figure comes from a single non-randomised study in Cuba, and the authors note a "remarkable paucity of reliable evidence".

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**Transferability:** the trial evidence is for *Aedes aegypti*, which was eradicated from Mauritius in the 1950s. The vector here is *Ae. albopictus*, which also breeds in small containers and natural sites around the home, so covers alone are weaker against it. That is why the action pairs covers with clean-ups. Port Louis is rationed: since 5 August 2026 the zone gets water 04:00–08:00 and 16:00–20:00, 8 hours a day, and the restrictions of 3 August ban car washes and filling pools.

## 4. Before December, issue an arbovirus care protocol for people over 50 and people with diabetes, and start monthly excess-death monitoring by age

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ministry of Health and Wellness, with Statistics Mauritius | 1 December 2026 | Staff time and a data-sharing agreement | Deaths in older and diabetic patients going unseen, as in 2006 |

Mauritius is coming out of its largest chikungunya epidemic since 2005–06: 6,891 confirmed cases by 28 August 2026 (NY State Global Health Update), mostly from mid-April to early May (the 12 July count of 6,675 included 92 on Rodrigues), with new cases now running at 13–23 a week. The hotspots were Rose-Hill, Quatre-Bornes, Stanley, Beau-Bassin, and Chemin-Grenier; no Port Louis count was found. In 2006 the epidemic coincided with an estimated 743 excess deaths from March to May, which showed only in all-cause mortality, not in case counts. A small 2010 reanalysis put 91.5% of that excess in people aged 50 and over. Port Louis has 19,368 people aged 65 or over (13.8%; Census 2022, Statistics Mauritius), and a 2021 national survey reported diabetes in 19.9% of adults aged 25–74 (secondary report). The protocol adapts WHO's July 2025 guideline for dengue and chikungunya care, which names older people with underlying conditions as the high-risk group. The monitoring uses Civil Status death registrations, which Statistics Mauritius already receives monthly, against a 2015–2025 baseline that leaves out 2020–22.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**Corrections:** monthly, not weekly, unless a data-sharing agreement makes weekly possible. The suggestion that Port Louis's older population is largely non-immune going into the summer is an inference; no seroprevalence study tests it.

## 5. Finish demolishing the Rogers car park over the Ruisseau du Pouce before December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MANAGER · HISTORIAN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Municipal City Council of Port Louis | 30 November 2026 | Unpublished; agreement already signed | A structure over the stream narrowing it in a flood |

The Ruisseau du Pouce has been named three times. The 2008 Domah committee told the government to remove the Rogers and Air Mauritius car parks built over it, and Magistrate Rambarun's inquest into the 2013 deaths, published on 29 December 2015, named the same structures. The KFC building and the hawkers' slab over the river came down first (their dates were not found); the Air Mauritius car park, the first of the two car parks the committee named, was demolished in July 2026. The council has a signed agreement with Rogers, the roof is already off, and the mayor said demolition starts once the Air Mauritius site is finished. No date has been given.

**Correction:** the flood benefit is not quantified. The only stated rationale is "restoring natural flow"; no hydraulic study was found. Removing a structure over a channel plausibly helps, which is why this ranks below the actions whose effect is direct.

## 6. By December, build a street-by-street "who's alone" register and send flood warnings as Kreol voice notes through faith networks

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FRONTLINE · PUBLIC HEALTH | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Caritas Île Maurice, with parishes, mosques, and temple committees | 1 December 2026 | Volunteer time; Rs 0.5M alert pilot in the funding section | Older, disabled, and house-bound people left alone in a flood or hot spell |

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Pair each older, disabled, or house-bound person, and each family in a fragile house in a flood zone, with a neighbour who has their number, in Plaine Verte, Roche Bois, Vallée Pitot, Tranquebar, and Ste Croix. Caritas is headquartered in Port Louis (Rue d'Estaing) with 46 listening centres and 47 parishes. Use the same pairs for checks during hot spells. Over 90% of Port Louis speaks Kreol at home (130,643 of 140,403 people; Census 2022, Statistics Mauritius), so warnings go out as short Kreol voice notes through imams, priests, and temple committees, along the lines of "Lapli for: pa pas dan tinel Caudan, pa reste dan parking anba later, pa travers larivyer", checked by a native speaker first. Official warnings have little credit: the met-service director resigned after Belal, and CWA tanker drivers in Vallée Pitot were investigated for selling water in 2025.*

**Corrections:** Lovebridge's roughly 400 families are spread across more than 100 localities island-wide, not concentrated in Port Louis, so it is a referral source, not the starting list. A reported 2024 house collapse in Tranquebar could not be verified. The evidence for buddy checks comes from the 1995 Chicago heat wave (living alone OR 2.3; confined to bed OR 8.2), a different hazard and city. It is the best available evidence for the principle, not a measured effect here.

## 7. Pre-authorise flood cash before the rains: pay Social Register households in mapped flood zones on a warning, by bank transfer, with no police memo

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST · PHILANTHROPIST | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: PRECEDENT (BANGLADESH, 2021)

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ministry of Social Integration, Social Security and National Solidarity, through NEF | Circular by 30 November 2026 | Draws on the national trigger-cash line MU-F01 (Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8M cap per trigger, shared by all six zones); not in this envelope | Families going without food and repairs while waiting for proof of loss |

Every flood payment in Mauritius moves after the event. The Flood Allowance pays Rs 250 per family member a day for up to three days, only on a police memo. After the rains of 15 March 2026 in Rodrigues, Rs 2.795M of relief was announced on 4 April, about three weeks later: Rs 795k from the National Empowerment Foundation (Rs 15,000 per household for repairs, Rs 5,000 for basic needs, and Rs 5,000 per student, straight into bank accounts) and Rs 2M from the National Solidarity Fund. The NEF list was built with the police after the event: 62 families had been paid by mid-April. The payment rail works; the trigger is the gap. This briefing now asks for one national rule, not a Port Louis pot: Rs 5,000 a Social Register household on an MMS warning, capped at Rs 2.8M per trigger (the size of that combined Rodrigues run), paid by the NEF and NSF. The NEF allocates at the trigger from lists each zone prepares in advance; Port Louis's list is the

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Social Register households in the Land Drainage Master Plan's flood zones, with families missing from the Register referred through NGOs such as Lovebridge. The Climate Impact Lab Adaptation Inventory's closest precedent is anticipatory cash before floods in Bangladesh (2021), where going a day without eating fell by 36%.

**Corrections:** the warning trigger is a new design, not existing policy, and a permanent fund for climate-disaster victims announced in April 2025 has no launch on record. Main-island MMS warnings are island-wide, so the trigger fires for every main-island zone at once; that is why the six zones share one cap rather than each holding its own cash. The allowance rules come from a single press report, not a government text.

## 8. By mid-November, buy rice and flour cover through March and land onion, potato, and garlic stock before the cyclone season

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| State Trading Corporation (rice, flour); Agricultural Marketing Board (onion, potato, garlic) | Tenders closed by 15 November 2026 | Working capital; not quantified | Empty subsidised shelves, or emergency buying at peak prices, during the cyclone season |

The food pressure on Port Louis is real but it is not El Niño's. National food inflation rose from 2.7% in July to 6.2% in September 2026. The FAO Food Price Index for September was 136.0, up 5.8% on a year earlier, with cereals rising 5.1% in the month; FAO cites the Strait of Hormuz and Black Sea disruptions and mentions El Niño only for sugar. Shipping through Hormuz nearly stopped in March 2026, and the STC's fuel import bill rose to about $90M for March–April, on the same balance sheet that funds subsidised rice and flour. In March 2026 subsidised rice and flour vanished from shelves for about two weeks even though stocks covered rice to June: the break was distribution, not supply. The STC tenders rice in three-month windows, so the December–March window is decided now. The AMB clears onion, potato, and garlic imports; the Ministry of Agro-Industry pre-clears tomato and carrot permits, as it did for carrots after Cyclone Bansi.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**Corrections:** rice and flour are subsidised at fixed prices, not rationed. Leafy greens were dropped: they are too perishable to import usefully. **Triggers:** the FAO cereal trigger (+5% in a month) has already tripped, so treat the tender as on now. Food CPI above 8% year on year is usable with a five-week lag (monthly, about a week after month-end; currently 6.2%). The best early trigger is daily: the Agricultural Marketing Board publishes quantities and prices for 82 vegetables at the National Wholesale Market every trading day.

## 9. Have a temporary price order on key fresh vegetables ready to issue the day each cyclone warning is lifted

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | FOOD SUPPLY CHAIN | ADAPTATION INVENTORY: NONE FOUND

| OWNER | BY WHEN | COST | PREVENTS |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ministry of Commerce, enforced by the Consumer Affairs Unit | Order drafted by 1 December 2026 | Inspector overtime | Opportunistic price spikes at the Central Market after a cyclone |

The legal basis exists: the Consumer Protection (Price and Supplies Control) Act 2012 and a maximum mark-up regime covering 1,510 products. So does the capacity: the Consumer Affairs Unit made 11,567 inspections and issued 1,215 fines from July 2025 to July 2026. The gap is that fresh vegetables are not mark-up controlled, so after a cyclone inspectors have nothing to enforce. The Price Stabilisation Fund (Rs 2.0bn in 2026-27) subsidises packaged groceries, not fresh produce.

**Correction:** the lens proposed inspections alone; without an order there is nothing to inspect against. No record of standing post-cyclone sweeps was found. The subsidised-product count is about 500, not 485.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

**R** = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

| Action | MCCPL | LDA | MoHW | CWA | MSI / NEF | NDRRMC | Police | Caritas & faith networks | STC / AMB | Commerce |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1. Gate and shut underground spaces | **A** | **C** | | | | **C** | **R** | **I** | | |
| 2. Clear Pouce, Dayot, Vallijee drains | **R** | **A/R** | | | | **I** | | | | |
| 3. "Covered" storage and lid condition on the voucher | **R** | | **A** | **R** | | | | **R** | | |
| 4. Arbovirus protocol and excess-death watch | | | **A/R** | | | **I** | | | | |
| 5. Rogers car park demolition | **A/R** | **C** | | | | | | | | |
| 6. Buddy register and Kreol warnings | **C** | | | | **I** | **C** | | **A/R** | | |
| 7. Flood cash on a warning | | **C** | | | **A/R** | **C** | | **R** | | |
| 8. Rice, flour, and vegetable stock | | | | | | | | | **A/R** | **C** |
| 9. Post-cyclone vegetable price order | **I** | | | | | | | | **C** | **A/R** |

What the chart shows: the City Council carries the most rows (six) and is accountable for two: the underground closures, the top-ranked action, and the Rogers demolition (ranked fifth). Four rows need a decision rather than money: the closure rule (1), the lid condition (3), the payment circular (7), and the price order (9). Statistics Mauritius (row 4), the Caudan operator (row 1), and the Ministry of Finance (row 3) also hold roles but are not given columns. MCCPL = Municipal City Council of Port Louis; LDA = Land Drainage Authority; MoHW = Ministry of Health and Wellness; MSI = Ministry of Social Integration, Social Security and National Solidarity; NEF = National Empowerment Foundation; NDRRMC = National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Centre.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by marginal lives saved per dollar. The envelope is bounded by what this place can spend before the peak, not by what it needs.

FLOOR

**Rs 0.6M (about $12k)**

TARGET

**Rs 1.1M (about $23k)**

CEILING

**Rs 2.3M (about $48k)**

LARGEST UNCERTAINTY

**Whether the Ministry of Health can spend the covers money before the peak**

At the MRA customs rate of Rs 48.1061 per US dollar (week 41, 12 October 2026). **Floor** = F3, a 1,000-household covers pilot at Rs 600 = Rs 0.6M. **Target** = floor + F2 Rs 0.5M = Rs 1.1M. **Ceiling** = target + F4, covers scaled to 3,000 households in all (+Rs 1.2M) = Rs 2.3M; above this, the delivery partners, not the money, are the limit. **The envelope fell from Rs 2.5M / 3.0M / 6.5M on 14 October because the Rs 2.5M flood-**

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**cash placement, almost all of the old floor, moved to the national trigger-cash line MU-F01, which is counted once for all six zones rather than in each.** Earlier, in verification, the target had already fallen from Rs 11.0M when the Lovebridge cash placement (Rs 2.0M) was contraindicated. The largest single uncertainty is now the Ministry of Health: it must confirm in writing, by 15 November, that it can spend the covers money (one check across the three Ministry placements in the set), and until it does only the 1,000-household pilot is released.

| RECIPIENT | USE | AMOUNT | MECHANISM | BASIS | VERDICT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ministry of Health vector control, with the City Council | F3. Covers pilot: a kit (lid or cover, mesh, larvicide where safe) for 1,000 households with existing uncovered storage in rationed cités (action 3)* | Rs 0.6M ($12k) | Pre-positioned stock | Rs 600 a household kit, the set-wide unit. It is an assumption: there is no Mauritian quote, so release money only against a written supplier quote. Pilot scale only until the Ministry of Health confirms in writing, by 15 November, that it can spend it (one check across the three Ministry placements in the set). Households getting the new voucher tank should get their lid through the voucher condition, not this line | UNVERIFIED |
| Mauritius Red Cross Society | F2. Capped pilot of volunteer flood alerting in two cités (action 6) | Rs 0.5M ($10k) | Direct grant | No published unit cost. The amount is a cap, not a costing. No Port Louis branch or documented Port Louis response was found, so release it only when the society shows it can deliver here | UNVERIFIED |
| Ministry of Health vector control, with the City Council | F4. Covers scaled from 1,000 to 3,000 households (action 3) | Rs 1.2M ($25k), ceiling only | Pre-positioned stock | 2,000 more kits at Rs 600 (an assumption, as F3). Released only after the Ministry's written check. 3,000 households is a cap, not a count: about one in thirteen of the zone's roughly 40,000 households (about 131,000 people, WorldPop 2020 estimate, at an assumed 3.3 a household). No count of households storing water uncovered exists | UNVERIFIED |

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

| RECIPIENT | USE | AMOUNT | MECHANISM | BASIS | VERDICT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| National Empowerment Foundation and National Solidarity Fund (MSI) | Flood cash for Social Register households in mapped flood zones, released on a warning (action 7) | Draws on the national trigger-cash line MU-F01 (Rs 5,000 a household, Rs 2.8M cap per trigger, shared by all six zones): **not counted in this envelope**. The cap is the size of the largest comparable payout, Rs 2.795M to Rodrigues after the rains of 15 March 2026 (NEF Rs 795k plus NSF Rs 2M; L'Express via allAfrica, 4 April 2026). Port Louis prepares its list in advance; the NEF allocates at the trigger | | | |

The funder's one thing: in Port Louis the cheapest lives are saved by decisions, not grants. Gating the underground spaces, a one-word change to CWA messages, a lid condition on a voucher already funded, and a payment circular cost almost nothing. Money cannot buy them; it can only lobby for them. Do not fund a generic dengue awareness programme: the best-evidenced one, Camino Verde, cost about $29,000 per DALY averted and was judged not cost-effective in Nicaragua.

## Do not do this

CONTRAINDICATED · ADVICE THAT WOULD COST LIVES HERE

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives here.

### Do not shelter from a downpour underground, or cross a ruisseau or drive into a flooded road

CONTRAINDICATED

In 2013 most of the dead were found in a pedestrian subway and an underground car park, places people went into to get out of the rain, and at the Ruisseau du Pouce and Canal Dayot. In Belal the one death was a motorcyclist found on a flooded highway, and about 100 vehicles were submerged or abandoned in Port Louis.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**Instead:** go up, not down. Wait in an upper floor or one of the 16 buildings in the city's flood plan, and stay off roads and bridges over the streams until the water drops.*

### Do not wait for the MMS warning before closing underground spaces or releasing people

CONTRAINDICATED

The warning gave effectively no lead time in either of the last two deadly events. In 2013 residents said no warning came; in 2024 the Prime Minister said the rain was not anticipated and the met-service director resigned. A rule that waits for the bulletin would have closed the Caudan subway after the water was in it.

**Instead:** close on the warning *or* on the keyholder's own sight of intense rain, whichever comes first (action 1).

### Do not tell households to "store water" without saying "covered"

CONTRAINDICATED

The CWA's advice to keep "sufficient reserves" says nothing about covers. Where supply is intermittent, stored water in uncovered tanks and drums is a main mosquito breeding site (Laos and Thailand, 2017), and Mauritius enters the dengue season in a water deficit.

**Instead:** "store water covered, scrub weekly", in the same message as the supply schedule (action 3).

### Do not make insecticide fogging the visible response to dengue or chikungunya

CONTRAINDICATED

A systematic review of 15 studies found that space spraying's effect on mosquito numbers did not last and found no evidence of an effect on disease; a 2016 meta-analysis found no randomised trials of fogging against dengue. Fogging is the routine response in Mauritius, and WHO supplied 1,000 L of a pyrethroid in 2024, but no data on local insecticide resistance has been published.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

**Instead:** remove and cover breeding sites, and keep spraying for case clusters until the resistance results are public.

### Do not frame this season as an "El Niño drought"

CONTRAINDICATED

Across 20 stations, Pacific and Indian Ocean indices together explain almost none of Mauritius's monthly rainfall (mean adjusted $R^2$ 0.036). The 1998–99 record drought fell in La Niña; the 2023–24 El Niño summer was wet and brought the largest dengue outbreak on record. The MMS bulletin of 10 August 2026 puts October–December rain at about 92% of normal (near-normal to slightly dry), warmer than normal; the SARCOF-33 regional forecast is normal to above-normal rain for January–March 2027. Priming people for dry heat weakens readiness for the cloudburst that kills.

**Instead:** "a water deficit carried over from a dry summer, mosquitoes, and the 90-minute cloudburst".

### Do not route emergency cash through organisations that have never run cash transfers

CONTRAINDICATED

The panel proposed Rs 2.0M in cash to Lovebridge's families. Lovebridge is based in Saint Pierre, its roughly 400 families are spread across more than 100 localities island-wide, and it gives in-kind help only. Caritas's only distribution on record is COVID food packs. Money given to a channel that has never paid cash will not reach anyone before the peak.

**Instead:** pay through NEF, which has paid flood grants by bank transfer, and use NGOs to refer families missing from the Social Register (action 7).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

| YEAR | EVENT | TOLL | WHAT CHANGED AFTER |
|---|---|---|---|
| Feb 1865 | The Pouce, Butte à Tonniers, and Pucelles streams overflow; a historian blamed railway works blocking the outflow | 30 drowned (single secondary source) | Not recorded |
| 1866–68 | Malaria epidemic, starting in Port Louis | About 40,000 deaths, roughly a tenth of the island's population (1867) | The capital's population moved to the plateau towns |
| Feb 1960 | Cyclones Alix and Carol | 8 and 42 dead island-wide; about 70,000 homes destroyed by Carol | "Cyclone-proof" cités built for the homeless |
| 2006 | Chikungunya epidemic | 743 excess all-cause deaths, Mar–May (no cause-of-death data) | Visible only in all-cause mortality |
| Mar 2008 | Flood at Mon Goût, on the edge of Port Louis | 4 dead (thin record) | Domah committee names the structures over the Ruisseau du Pouce |
| 2009 | Dengue re-emerges, cluster in the Port Louis suburbs | Deaths not recorded | Nothing structural |
| 30 Mar 2013 | Flash flood: more than 150 mm in under 90 minutes (ENSO-neutral) | 11 dead, most in a subway, an underground car park, and at the streams | Inquest (published Dec 2015) names the same structures; the KFC building and hawkers' slab came down first, and the first named car park (Air Mauritius) in July 2026 |

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

| YEAR | EVENT | TOLL | WHAT CHANGED AFTER |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dec 2023 – Apr 2024 | Largest dengue outbreak on record (El Niño summer); Port Louis the hotspot | 3,311 cases main island + 1,363 Rodrigues, 4 deaths to 19 Mar 2024 (WHO AFRO); then about 7,177 cases and 15 deaths nationally by 28 Apr (TravelHealthPro, secondary). Government figure: 6,673 cases and 8 deaths (June 2024) | Fogging and WHO insecticide supply |
| 15 Jan 2024 | Cyclone Belal floods the capital (El Niño year) | 1 dead; about 100 vehicles submerged in Port Louis | Met-service director resigned; uninsured cars compensated by the state |
| 2025–26 | Summer with 66% of normal rain; national reservoirs at 59.7% on 29 Sep 2026 against 90.3% a year earlier | No deaths recorded | Port Louis zone on 8 hours a day (04:00–08:00 and 16:00–20:00) since 5 Aug 2026 |
| 2026 | Largest chikungunya epidemic since 2005–06 | 6,891 confirmed cases by 28 Aug; deaths not reported | Too early to say |

The recurrence nobody has noticed: Port Louis has been told to stop building over the Pouce three times in 150 years. In 1865 the blockage was railway works across the outflow; in 2008 a committee named the car parks; in 2015 an inquest named them again after 11 people died. The first of the named car parks came down in July 2026, eighteen years after it was named. The deadliest Port Louis floods fell in neutral and La Niña years. The hazard that recurs is not the weather; it is the promise that is made after the deaths and kept a decade later.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **Close on the MMS warning** (Emergency manager, Economist) versus **close on observed rainfall** (Skeptic, Historian). Verification sided with the second on the record (zero lead time in 2013 and 2024), but a gauge trigger does not exist yet. A working rain-gauge network in the Pouce basin would settle it; until then the keyholder's judgment is the trigger.
- **Fund door-to-door dengue mobilisation** (Public health: Camino Verde cut infection in children by 29.5%) versus **do not fund it** (Philanthropist: about $29,000 per DALY, not cost-effective in Nicaragua). The trial was on *Ae. aegypti*. Resolved here as volunteer clean-ups, unfunded, rather than a paid programme.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Put Port Louis first in the tank programme** (Economist) versus **tanks are new breeding sites** (Public health). Cabinet's 9 October extension to every household without a tank settles the first point, so the action makes a lid the condition of the voucher.
- **Chikungunya is the bigger threat this summer** (Public health) versus **the epidemic is waning** (13–23 new cases a week by late August). A seroprevalence survey of older Port Louis residents would settle whether the city is still largely non-immune.

## WHAT NOBODY COVERED

BLIND SPOT

Two gaps. First, no lens looked at the zone's own water sources. Pailles treatment plant (80,000 m³/day) draws on the Grand River North West, and Bagatelle reservoir, which also serves the zone, was at 66.1% on 29 September against 95.9% a year earlier; La Ferme, on the western edge, was at 42.5%. If Bagatelle follows Mare aux Vacoas down, the 8-hour schedule will shorten, and the storage-and-mosquito problem in action 3 grows with it. Second, no lens examined landslides and rockfall on the slopes around the city (Signal Mountain, Le Pouce, the Montagne des Signaux cités) in the same cloudbursts that flood the streams. If those slopes have a record, the buddy register and the flood-zone payment list in actions 6 and 7 need to cover them too.

## HOW TO READ THIS

METHOD

**The panel is author-built.** Eight simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale; Port Louis's region also takes in Plaines Wilhems, about 447,000 people in all. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*; drought, flood, fire, smoke, and crop failure are additional to it and are carried here by the historical record rather than by a published number.

## HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The location was taken as the Central Water Authority's Port Louis supply zone, the second of six Mauritius briefings aligned to CWA supply zones (decision of 13 October 2026). The city's population is the Municipal Council area's 140,403 (Census 2022, Statistics Mauritius, including Pailles), not the district's 106,332. The zone total is not published by the census; the GIS base gives about 131,000 (WorldPop

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

2020 estimate). Climate Impact Lab impact region: MUS.Rb4955ae83edc3e08 (label unconfirmed), decoded from the Impact Map's own boundary file. Mauritius has three impact regions; this one covers Port Louis and Plaines Wilhems districts (Rose Hill, Curepipe), about 447,000 people (Census 2022 figures for the two districts, 106,332 and 340,780). The label the map displays for it was not confirmed in a live browser. Mortality figures exist only at that scale; sub-city detail is used for hazard exposure and action design, not for death counts.

- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only and publishes no figure for Mauritius. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality. Heat is not the dominant hazard here, so the historical record carries the hazard instead of a borrowed number.
- **Expert panel.** Eight simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, philanthropist, and food supply chain analyst) each researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. The national premise came from two verified Storm research reports of 13 October 2026 (briefing scope, and map design).
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias (whether the evidence behind an agreed action came from a setting like this one) before it counted in an action's favour. Contradictions were kept, not resolved by dropping a side. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak, each was given a named payer and trigger or marked unfunded, and the funding placements were reconciled against the ranked list.
- **Verification.** Six verifier agents (flood, vector-borne disease, health and community, finance, food, and the funding envelope) checked every recommendation on three tests: evidence (the primary source and its effect size), transferability (whether that evidence came from somewhere like here), and feasibility (whether it can be done here before the peak). Financial actions were also checked for availability in this jurisdiction, a named payer, a trigger threshold, and whether they already exist. The funding envelope was checked for real recipients, published unit costs, and duplication, then re-summed. Disputed national figures (the 2023–24 dengue toll, the 2026 chikungunya epidemic) were settled against WHO AFRO and Africa CDC relays and are recorded with their dates.
- **Who does what.** The RACI chart is built from the owners named in the verified actions, with one accountable party per action. It is a proposal: no organisation named in it has been contacted or has agreed to a role.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Consulted. The download sits behind a form, but the full dataset (96 entries) is embedded in the inventory page and was parsed from there. It holds no entry for Mauritius, for any small island state or the Southwest Indian Ocean, or on dengue, vector control,

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

water rationing, or urban flash-flood warning. The one relevant precedent is anticipatory cash before floods in Bangladesh (2021), tagged on action 7. "None found" on the other actions means the inventory was searched and holds nothing comparable.

- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (checks on older and house-bound people, larvicide in stored water, and what to do in a flash flood) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so and shows the containing geography's number with its arithmetic. Every source is listed below with its verification status.
- **Limits.** The panel and verifiers are AI research agents working from web-available sources, not human experts, and no one in this place was interviewed. Much of the 2026 record reaches us through Mauritian press (L'Express via AllAfrica), and several AllAfrica pages returned HTTP 403, so some quotes were confirmed from headlines and search snippets only. The Statistics Mauritius CPI release, the 2021 NCD survey report, and any government text of the Flood Allowance could not be opened. The CWA supply-zone boundaries were not available; the zone's localities come from the CWA hours-of-supply schedule of 13 January 2025, and one 2021 article places Terre Rouge on the Pailles system, against the schedule. MMS gauge locations in Port Louis were not found. The Caudan subway and the Rogers car park have no point on the map: OpenStreetMap names neither (it shows two unnamed pedestrian tunnels near Place d'Armes), and no source fixed which is the 2013 subway, so no point was guessed.
- **Revised 2026-10-14 after the set audit** (fixes applied: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 9, 10, 21, 22, 23, 24, and 25; fix 8 needed no change here, since the 15 June communiqué covers the Mare aux Vacoas zones, not Port Louis; fix 26 not applied, for the reason above). The flood cash moved to the national line MU-F01, the covers use the set-wide Rs 600 unit with one Ministry of Health check, and every dollar figure is restated at Rs 48.1061 (MRA week 41).

---

References (✓ verified by a verifier agent against the primary source · ~ partly verified or secondary · ? not verified) · ~ IOL/AFP, Ten dead in Mauritius floods, 31 Mar 2013 · ✓ L'Express, Caudan memorial 13 years on, 31 Mar 2026 · ✓ L'Express, Port Louis Flood Response and Evacuation Plan, Mar 2026 · ✓ Al Jazeera, Mauritius battered by tropical downpour, 1 Apr 2013 · ~ MMS warning thresholds (PreventionWeb, 2009) · ✓ WMO, SW Indian Ocean flash-flood guidance project · ✓ L'Express, Air Mauritius car park demolition and Rogers agreement, 23 Jul 2026 · ✓ L'Express, LDA Rs 993M project list, May 2026 · ~ L'Express, Flood Management Programme "blocked since 2019", Apr 2025 · ✓ L'Express, Land Drainage Master Plan release, Aug 2025 · ✓ L'Express, pre-season drain cleaning meeting, Sep 2025 · ✓ AllAfrica, drainage contractor delivery, Jun 2026 · ✓ News24, Belal floods, 15 Jan 2024 · ✓ AP/CTV, Belal, 1 death, Jan 2024 · ✓ WHO AFRO, dengue outbreak, 21 Mar 2024 · ~ TravelHealthPro, dengue 7,177 cases, Apr 2024 · ~ Crisis24, Port Louis dengue hotspot, Feb 2024 · ~ TravelHealthPro/Africa CDC, chikungunya 6,675 cases, Jul 2026 · ✓ NY State

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Global Health Update, chikungunya 6,891 cases to 28 Aug 2026 · ✓ Beesoon et al., Chikungunya, Mauritius, 2006 (EID 2008) · ~ Ramchurn et al. 2010, excess mortality by age · ✓ Issack et al., Reemergence of dengue in Mauritius (EID 2010) · ✓ Mauritius SIT pilot, Panchvati (bioRxiv) · ✓ Bowman et al. 2016, dengue vector control meta-analysis · ✓ Andersson et al. 2015, Camino Verde (BMJ) · ✓ Tschampl et al. 2020, Camino Verde cost-effectiveness · ✓ Esu et al. 2010, space spraying review · ✓ Vannavong et al. 2017, water storage and Aedes · ✓ L'Express, CWA advice on water reserves, Oct 2025 · ✓ L'Express, fumigation at Roches-Brunes, Jan 2026 · ✓ AllAfrica, water tank grants, Feb 2025 · ✓ 5plus, Cabinet extends the tank grant as a Rs 15,000 voucher, 10 Oct 2026 (press; scheme rules not published) · ✓ EY, Mauritius Budget 2026-27 synopsis · ✓ L'Express, supply cut and La Nicolière level, Aug 2026 · ✓ CWA, new supply hours from 5 Aug 2026 · ✓ CWA, restrictions communiqué, 3 Aug 2026 · ✓ CWA, hours of supply by locality, Jan 2025 · ✓ CWA Annual Report 2024-25 · ✓ ION News, WRC reservoir levels, 29 Sep 2026 · ✓ Pople et al., anticipatory cash before floods, Bangladesh (Adaptation Inventory) · ✓ Climate Impact Lab, impact region boundaries · ✓ WHO 2025 arboviral clinical guideline · ✓ WHO chikungunya fact sheet · ✓ Statistics Mauritius, civil registration and vital statistics · ✓ City Population, Port-Louis, 2022 census · ~ AllAfrica, NCD Survey 2021 diabetes figure (secondary) · ✓ Semenza et al. 1996, Chicago heat deaths · ✓ Hess et al. 2018, Ahmedabad heat action plan · ✓ Santé publique France, heat mortality in overseas regions · ✓ Actogether, Lovebridge profile · ✓ Caritas Africa, Caritas Mauritius · ✓ L'Express, CWA tanker investigation, Feb 2025 · ✓ L'Express, families missing from the Social Register, Feb 2026 · ~ L'Express, Flood Allowance rules, 16 Apr 2025 · ✓ L'Express, NEF payments after the Rodrigues floods, 16 Apr 2026 · ✓ L'Express via allAfrica, Rodrigues relief Rs 2.795M (NEF Rs 795k + NSF Rs 2M), 4 Apr 2026 (basis of MU-F01) · ~ Forvis Mazars, CCR levy · ✓ FSC communiqué on flooded vehicles, 16 Jan 2024 · ✓ MRA customs rate of exchange, week 41 of 2026 (Rs 48.1061, 12 Oct) · ~ Early Warning System tracker, World Bank P173591 Cat DDO (never approved; the follow-on DPF was dropped in May 2025) · ✓ African Risk Capacity treaty status list, Jul 2024 (verified in the scope report) · ✓ PIROI, Mauritius Red Cross Society · ✓ Trading Economics, Mauritius CPI, 7 Oct 2026 · ✓ MercoPress, FAO Food Price Index, Sep 2026 · ✓ L'Express, STC fuel import bill, Apr 2026 · ✓ L'Express, subsidised rice and flour shortage, Mar 2026 · ✓ AMB, daily National Wholesale Market prices · ✓ MCCI, import guide (AMB-controlled items) · ✓ Consumer Protection (Price and Supplies Control) Act 2012 · ✓ L'Express, Consumer Affairs inspections, Jul 2026 · ✓ SARCOF-33 statement, Aug 2026 · ~ L'Express, MMS El Niño bulletin, 11 Aug 2026 · ~ Staub et al. 2014, ENSO and Mauritius rainfall (slides) · ✓ Le Mauricien, history of Port Louis floods · ✓ Seetah, malaria in Mauritius (Springer) · ~ Seetah, Empire, environment and disease: an Indian Ocean case study (41,000 malaria deaths, 1867) · ~ Université de La Réunion (HAL), the 1867 epidemic (about 40,000 of 333,000) · ~ The Spectator, cyclones Alix and Carol, 1960 · ✓ expat.com, reservoir levels, 7 Oct 2026 (quotes WRC data) · ✓ Storm research: Mauritius briefing scope and map design, 13 Oct 2026 (internal)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

Generated 13 October 2026, revised 14 October 2026, for Port Louis, Mauritius. El Niño Ready is volunteer-run and is not affiliated with Climate Week NYC, The Climate Group, or Columbia University.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.